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AI



OpenAI launches Study Mode in ChatGPT

OpenAI announced Tuesday the launch of Study Mode, a new feature within ChatGPT that aims to help students develop their own critical thinking skills, rather than simply obtain answers to questions. With Study Mode enabled, ChatGPT will ask users questions to test their understanding and, in some cases, refuse to offer direct answers unless students engage with the material.

OpenAI says Study Mode is rolling out to logged in users on ChatGPT's Free, Plus, Pro, and Team plans starting Tuesday. The company expects to introduce Study Mode to its Edu subscribers, which largely consists of young people whose school administrator's have purchased a plan for the entire student body, in the coming weeks.

Study Mode is OpenAI's attempt to address [the millions of students who use ChatGPT in school](#). Studies have shown that using [ChatGPT can be a helpful tutor](#) for young people, but it also [may harm their critical thinking skills](#). A research paper released in June found that [people who use ChatGPT to write essays exhibit lower brain activity during the process](#) compared to those who use Google Search or nothing at all.

When ChatGPT first launched in 2022, its widespread use in school settings sparked fear among educators, leading to generative AI bans in many American school districts. By 2023, [some of those schools repealed their ChatGPT bans](#), and

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teachers around the country came to terms with the fact that ChatGPT would be a part of young people's lives from now on.

Now with the launch of Study Mode, OpenAI hopes to improve ChatGPT as a learning tool, and not just an answer engine. Anthropic launched a similar tool for its AI chatbot Claude, [called Learning Mode](#), in April.

Of course, there are limitations to how effective Study Mode truly is. Students can easily switch into the regular mode of ChatGPT if they just want an answer to a question. OpenAI's VP of Education, Leah Belsky, told TechCrunch in a briefing that the company is not offering tools for parents or administrators to lock students into Study Mode. However, Belsky said OpenAI may explore administrative or parental controls in the future.

That means it will take a committed student to use Study Mode — the kids have to really want to learn, not just finish their assignment.

- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

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OpenAI says Study Mode is the company's first step to improving learning in ChatGPT and aims to publish more information in the future about how students use generative AI throughout their education.

Topics: [AI](#) [ChatGPT](#) [Education](#) [OpenAI](#)



Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter | [X](#)

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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OpenAI's GPT-5 is here

OpenAI has launched GPT-5, a new flagship AI model that will power the company's next generation of ChatGPT.

GPT-5, which was released Thursday, is OpenAI's first "unified" AI model and combines the reasoning abilities of its [o-series](#) of models with the fast responses of its [GPT series](#). The next-generation model signals a new era for ChatGPT — and its creator, OpenAI — pointing to OpenAI's broader ambitions to develop AI systems that are [more like agents](#) than chatbots.

While [GPT-4](#) enabled AI chatbots to offer smart responses on a wide variety of questions, GPT-5 allows ChatGPT to complete a wide variety of tasks on behalf of users — such as generating software applications, navigating a user's calendar, or creating research briefs.

With GPT-5, OpenAI has also sought to make ChatGPT simpler to use. Instead of asking users to choose the right settings, GPT-5 comes equipped with a real-time router that decides how to offer the best answer, whether that's responding to user questions quickly or taking additional time to "think" through answers.

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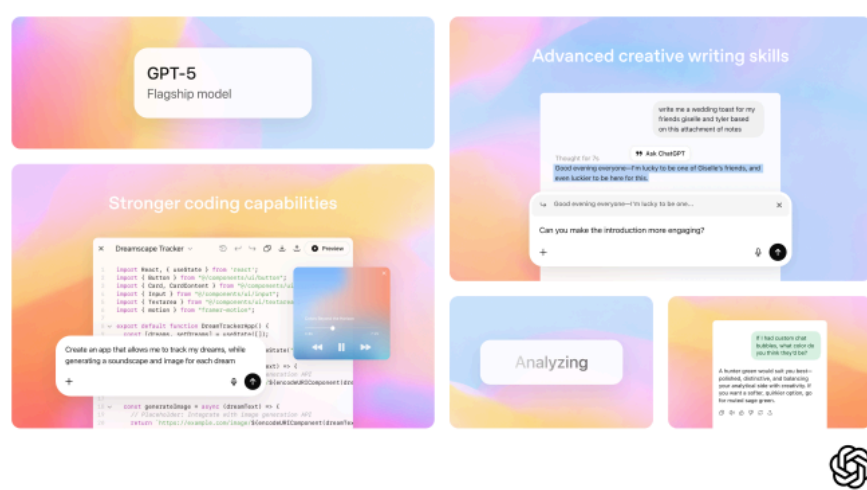


IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

During a briefing with reporters, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claimed GPT-5 is “the best model in the world,” and said it represented a “significant step” along the company’s path to developing AI that can outperform humans at most economically valuable work — that is, artificial general intelligence (AGI).

“Having something like GPT-5 would be pretty much unimaginable at any previous time in history,” said Altman.

Starting Thursday, GPT-5 will be available to all free users of ChatGPT as their default model. OpenAI’s VP of ChatGPT, Nick Turley, said this is part of the company’s effort to give free users access to an AI reasoning model for the first time. (Previously, the company gated these more advanced models behind a paywall.)

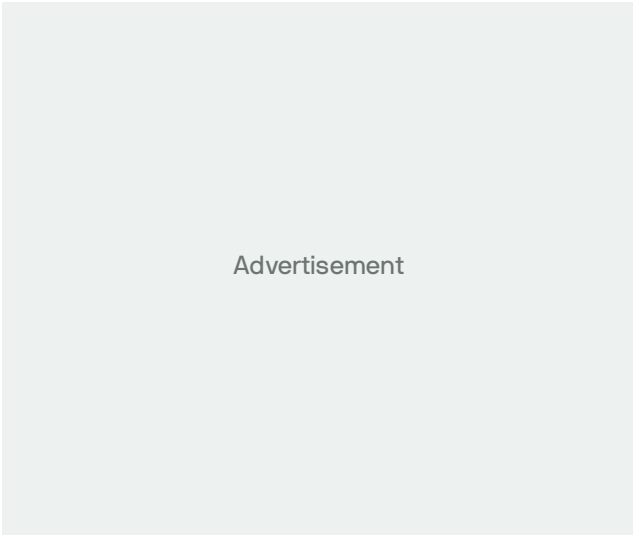
“This is just one of the ways that I’m excited to live the mission, making sure that this stuff actually benefits people,” said Turley on the decision, referencing OpenAI’s long-standing [mission](#) to distribute advanced AI to as many people as possible.

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The expectations are high for GPT-5, one of OpenAI's most anticipated product launches since ChatGPT put the company on the map in 2022. Since then, ChatGPT has grown into one of the world's most popular consumer products, reaching more than 700 million users every week — nearly 10% of the globe's population, according to the company.

Many see GPT-5 as a bellwether for AI progress broadly, and the model's reception by Silicon Valley could have profound implications for Big Tech, Wall Street, and policymakers regulating technology. These stakeholders are watching to see if GPT-5 offers a significant jump in AI's capabilities, much like its predecessor, GPT-4, which challenged expectations of what software can do.

GPT-5 offers a slight edge on the competition

OpenAI claims GPT-5 is state-of-the-art in several domains, slightly edging out leading AI models from Anthropic, Google DeepMind, and Elon Musk's xAI on key benchmarks. However, GPT-5 slightly underperforms frontier AI models in other areas.

The company says GPT-5 offers frontier-level performance around coding; Altman said the model specifically excels at spinning up entire software applications on demand, in what’s become known as “vibe coding.”

On SWE-bench Verified — a test of real-world coding tasks pulled from GitHub — GPT-5 scores 74.9% on its first attempt. That means GPT-5 just outperforms Anthropic’s latest Claude Opus 4.1 model, which scored [74.5%](#), and Google DeepMind’s Gemini 2.5 Pro, which scored [59.6%](#).

On Humanity’s Last Exam — a difficult test measuring AI model performance across math, humanities, and the natural sciences — a version of GPT-5 with extended reasoning (GPT-5 Pro) scored 42% when using tools. That’s slightly less than xAI was able to achieve with [Grok 4 Heavy](#), which scored 44.4% on the test.

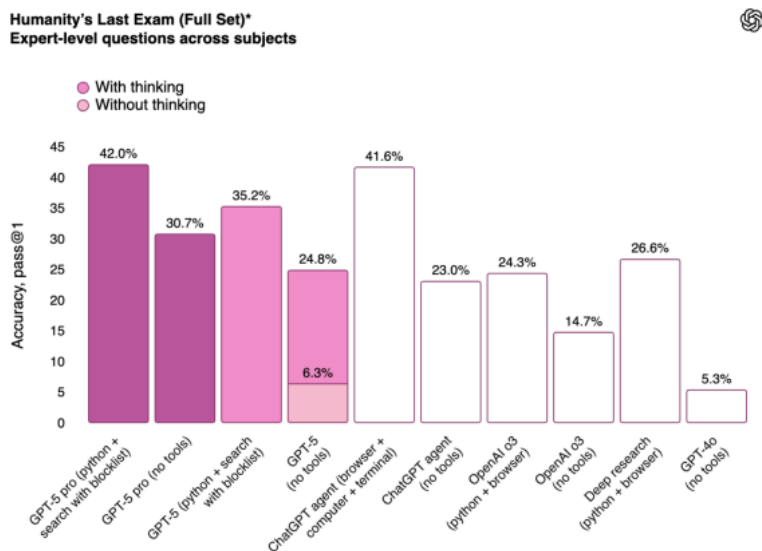


IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

On GPQA Diamond — a test of PhD-level science questions — GPT-5 pro scored 89.4% on its first try, outperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 80.9%, and Grok 4 Heavy, which scored 88.9%.

OpenAI says GPT-5 is better for answering health-related questions. On a test measuring accuracy in AI model responses around healthcare topics,

HealthBench Hard Hallucinations, OpenAI says GPT-5 (with thinking) hallucinates just 1.6% of the time. This is far lower than the company's previous GPT-4o and o3 models, which scored 12.9% and 15.8, respectively.

While AI chatbots are not medical professionals, [millions of people](#) are using them for health advice. In response to this phenomenon, the company says GPT-5 is more proactive about flagging potential health concerns and helping users parse medical results.

In addition, OpenAI says GPT-5 is better than other AI models on more difficult-to-measure, [subjective domains](#), such as creative design and writing. Turley said GPT-5 responds more naturally and exhibits “better taste” than other AI models on creative tasks.

“The vibes of this model are really good,” said Turley.

GPT-5 is also more accurate than OpenAI's previous models, and the company says it suffers far less from hallucinations — the tendency for AI models to make up information — compared to its o-series models. Hallucinations seemed to be [getting worse](#) in OpenAI's latest AI reasoning models, such as o3, and OpenAI previously said it didn't quite understand why it was happening.

In responses to ChatGPT prompts, OpenAI found that GPT-5 (with thinking) hallucinates and responds with incorrect information 4.8% of the time. That's a significant reduction from o3 and GPT-4o, which score hallucination rates of 22% and 20.6%, respectively, on the test.

On a benchmark measuring an AI model's agentic ability to complete simulated online tasks, Tau-bench, GPT-5 offers mixed performance. On part of

the test measuring an AI's ability to navigate an airline's website, GPT-5 scores 63.5%, slightly underperforming o3, which scored 64.8%. On another part of the test measuring AI's ability to navigate retail websites, GPT-5 scores 81.1%, underperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 82.4%.

OpenAI also says that GPT-5 is safer than its previous models. While AI reasoning models occasionally exhibit a tendency to [scheme against humans](#) or lie to promote their own goals, OpenAI found that GPT-5 was deceptive at a lower rate than other models.

Alex Beutel, OpenAI's safety research lead, said reducing deception improves not only the safety of GPT-5, but also the user experience, creating a model that's more "transparent and honest in ways users can trust."

Beutel also notes GPT-5 is better at discerning between bad actors who are trying to misuse ChatGPT and users making harmless requests. This results in GPT-5 being able to refuse more unsafe questions, while offering fewer rejections to users seeking harmless information.

Upgrades for consumers and developers

ChatGPT is getting a few user experience upgrades as part of the GPT-5 launch. Users can now select from four new personalities in ChatGPT's setting: Cynic, Robot, Listener, and Nerd. The company says these will adapt ChatGPT's responses without requiring users to specifically ask the model to respond in a certain way.

Subscribers to ChatGPT's \$20-per-month Plus plan get higher usage limits for GPT-5 than free users.

Meanwhile, \$200-per-month Pro subscribers will have unlimited access to GPT-5, as well as a souped-up version called GPT-5 Pro that uses additional computational resources to produce better answers. Organizations on OpenAI’s Team, Edu, and Enterprise plans will gain access to GPT-5 as their default model next week.

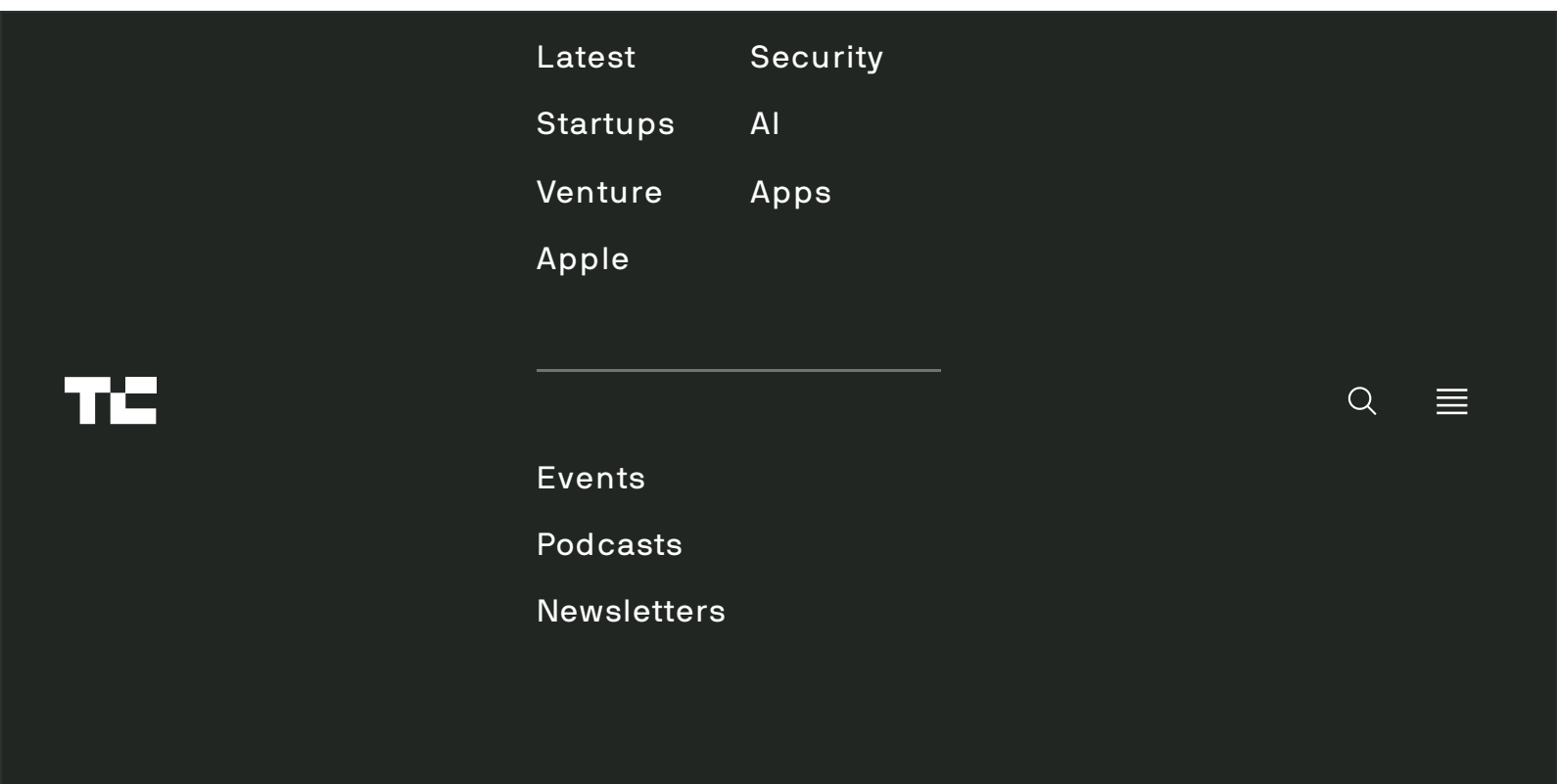
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For developers, GPT-5 is coming to OpenAI’s API in three sizes — gpt-5, gpt-5-mini, and gpt-5-nano — which will spend more or less time “reasoning” through tasks. Developers can also now control verbosity in the OpenAI API, deciding how long or short an AI model’s responses should be.



However, GPT-5 seems to be roughly on par with other frontier AI models in several areas. Benchmarks, of course, only tell part of the story for any AI model, and it remains to be seen how developers will use GPT-5 in the real world, and whether the model is truly a step above the competition.



Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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OpenAI is practically giving ChatGPT to the government for free

Rebecca Bellan — 10:09 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

OpenAI is poised to undercut rivals like Anthropic and Google in the race to see its AI tools integrated into federal agency workflows.

The AI giant has [reached an agreement](#) with the U.S. General Services Administration (GSA), the government's central purchasing arm, to offer ChatGPT Enterprise to participating federal agencies for just \$1 per agency for the next year.

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The partnership comes a day after the [GSA added OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic](#) to a list of approved AI vendors that can offer their services to civilian federal agencies. The companies will see their tools offered via the Multiple Award Schedule (MAS), a federal contracting platform that lets government agencies access AI tools via pre-negotiated contracts so they don't have to negotiate with vendors individually.

It's not clear whether other AI firms are going to offer their services at such a discounted rate, though GSA Federal Acquisition Service commissioner Josh Gruenbaum in a [statement](#) encouraged "other American AI technology companies to follow OpenAI's lead and work with us."

TechCrunch has reached out to Anthropic and Google for more information.

In addition to access to ChatGPT Enterprise, OpenAI is offering unlimited use of advanced models for an additional 60 days. Federal employees will also have access to a new government user community and tailored introductory training resources to get familiar with OpenAI's tools.

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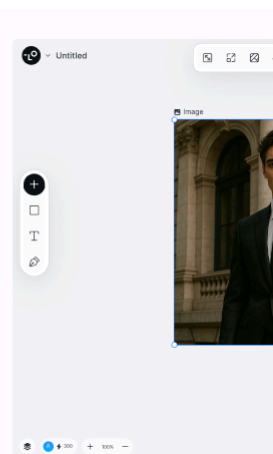
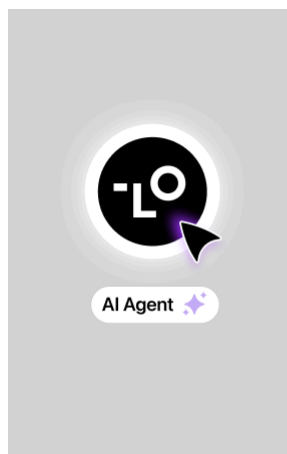
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Lovart's design agent hints at the future: AI-native brands built in minutes

Data security is a top priority for government agencies that are concerned about sensitive information being leaked into model training sets. TechCrunch has asked the GSA for details on how government data is being safeguarded, including whether measures like on-premises or private cloud deployments are being used to enhance security.



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“The government is taking a cautious, security-first approach to AI,” a GSA spokesperson told TechCrunch. “This ensures sensitive information remains protected while enabling agencies to benefit from AI-driven efficiencies.”

OpenAI's discount comes a couple of weeks after the Trump administration published its AI Action Plan that seeks to boost data center buildouts and integrate more AI tools into government, among other things. It also follows a Trump executive order that [bans “woke AI”](#) and AI models that aren't “ideologically neutral” from government contracts.

TechCrunch has reached out to OpenAI to learn more about its GSA partnership and how it will approach Trump’s executive order.

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Rebecca Bellan

Senior Reporter |

Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends...

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Google takes on ChatGPT’s Study Mode with new ‘Guided Learning’ tool in Gemini

As the new school year approaches, Google **announced** on Wednesday that it's launching a new tool called Guided Learning within Gemini. The tool sort of functions like an AI tutor, as it's designed to help users build a deep understanding instead of just getting answers.

Over a week after OpenAI rolled out **Study Mode for ChatGPT**, which is also designed to go beyond simply giving answers to questions by actually helping users develop critical thinking skills.

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Both companies' launches **come amid concerns** that AI chatbots **undermine the learning process** because they spit out direct answers. The new tools from Google and OpenAI likely aim to address these concerns by positioning their chatbots as learning tools rather than simple answer engines.

With Guided Learning, Gemini will break down problems step-by-step and adapt explanations to its users' needs. The feature responds using images, diagrams, videos, and interactive quizzes to help users build and test themselves on their knowledge, rather than simply giving them the answer.

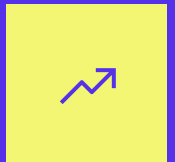
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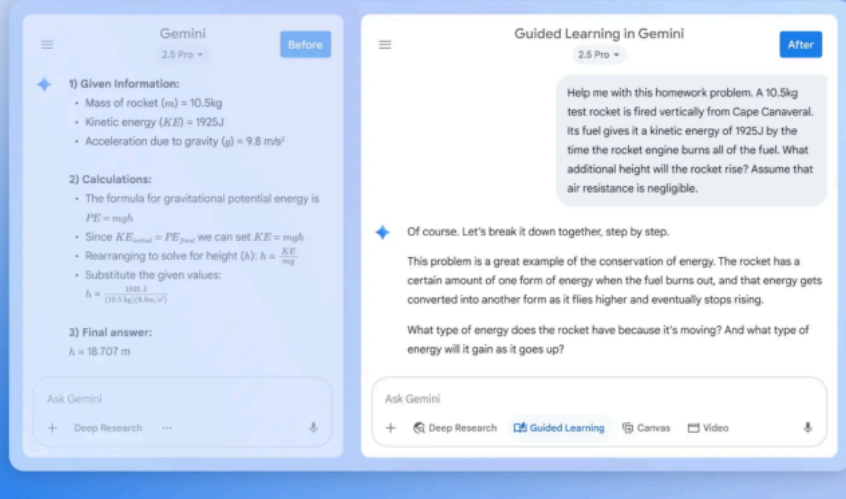


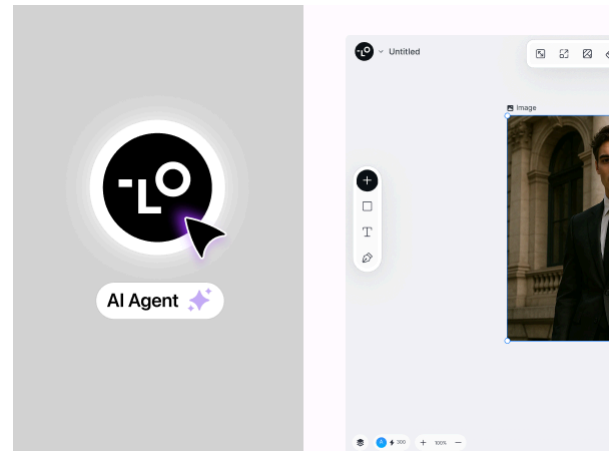
IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Google says the feature will help users uncover the “why” and “how” behind concepts.

“Whether you’re preparing for an exam about enzymes, starting the first draft of a paper on the importance of bee populations in supporting our food systems, or exploring your passion for photography, Guided Learning is a collaborative thinking partner that helps you get it — each step of the way,” wrote Maureen Heymans, Google’s VP of Learning & Sustainability, in the [blog post](#).

In addition to the new feature, Google announced that it’s working to make Gemini as a whole better equipped to help users learn. Gemini will now automatically incorporate images, diagrams, and YouTube videos directly into responses to help users better understand complex topics. Plus, users can now also ask Gemini to create flashcards and study guides based on their quiz results or other class materials.

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Google also announced on Wednesday that it's offering students in the U.S., Japan, Indonesia, Korea, and Brazil a free one-year subscription to Google's AI Pro plan.

The plan includes expanded access to [Gemini 2.5 Pro](#), [NotebookLM](#), [Veo 3](#), [Deep Research](#), and more.

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